Chapter 2

Writing Skills

Learning objectives

- Identify the parts of a formal letter.
- Apply appropriate tone and style for professional communication.
- Write different types of business correspondence.
- Prepare a CV and cover letter for job applications.
- Comprehend the report writing (formal and informal reports and the format of reports).

1. Formal Letters & Commercial Letters

The Purpose of Formal Letters

- Used in professional, academic, and official contexts.
- Aim to communicate clearly, concisely, and politely.
- Requires adherence to conventions (format, tone, structure).

Parts of a Formal Letter

1. *Sender's Address*
2. *Date*
3. *Recipient's Address*
4. *Attention line*
5. *Salutation* (Dear Mr./Ms./Dr. + Last Name)
6. *Body* – opening, main message, closing
7. *Complimentary close* (Sincerely, Yours faithfully, etc.)
8. *Signature* + typed name

Example of a Formal Letter

Sender's address	1 Bredgade 51 DK 1260 Copenhagen K DENMARK
Date	2 6 May 20—
Inside address	3 Compuvision Ltd Warwick House Warwick Street Forest Hill London SE23 1JF UK
Attention line	4 **For the attention of the Sales Manager**
Salutation	5 Dear Sir or Madam
Body of the letter	6 Please would you send me details of your DVD video systems. I am particularly interested in the Omega range.
Complimentary close	7 Yours faithfully
Signature	8 *B. Kaasen* (Ms) B. Kaasen

Figure 1: Example of a Formal Letter. Source: Ashley, A. (2020). Oxford Handbook of Commercial Correspondence.

Tone and Style

- ***Tone***: professional, respectful, and concise.
- Avoid slang, contractions, or overly casual expressions.
- ***Style***: active voice, clear sentence structure, objective language.
- Example
- ❌ "I'm writing to say that I can't deliver."
- ✅ "I regret to inform you that delivery will be delayed."

Commercial Letter – Enquiries, Replies and Quotations

- ***Making Enquiries***
  - ❖ A simple enquiry can be made by email, letter, or fax. The contents of an enquiry will depend on three things:
    - ➢ How well you *know the supplier*, whether the *supplier is based in your country or abroad*, and *the type of goods or service*s you are enquiring about.

Commercial Letter – Enquiries, Replies and Quotations (Cont.)

- ***Making Enquiries - Opening***
  - *Tell your supplier what sort of organization you are.*
    - We are a co-operative wholesale society based in Zurich.
    - Our company is a subsidiary of Universal Business Machines and we specialize in . . .
    - Etc.
  - *How did you hear about the company you are contacting?*
    - We were given your name by the Hoteliers' Association in Paris.
    - You were recommended to us by Mr John King, of Lawsom & Davies, Merchant Bankers; etc.

Commercial Letter – Enquiries, Replies and Quotations (Cont.)

- ***Making Enquiries - Opening***
  - *It is possible to use other references.*
    - We were impressed by the selection of gardening tools displayed on your stand at this year's Hamburg Gardening Exhibition.
    - Our associates in the packaging industry speak highly of your Zeta packing machines, and we would like to have more information about them. Could you send us . .
    - Etc.

Commercial Letter – Enquiries, Replies and Quotations (Cont.)

- ***Making Enquiries – Asking for catalogues, price lists, etc.***
  - *Asking for catalogues, price lists, etc.*
    - Could you please send your current catalogue and price list for exhibition stands? We are particularly interested in stands suitable for displaying furniture.
    - Please would you send me an up-to-date price list for your building materials.
    - I am planning to come and study in London next autumn and would be grateful if you could send me a prospectus and details of your fees. I am particularly interested in courses in computing.
    - Etc.

Commercial Letter – Enquiries, Replies and Quotations (Cont.)

- ***Making Enquiries – Asking for details***
  - *Asking for details.*
    - Could you please give me more information about course BL 362, which appears in the language-learning section of your summer prospectus.
    - I would appreciate more details about the 'University Communications System' which you are currently advertising on your website.
    - I am replying to your advertisement in the June edition of 'Tailor and Cutter'. I would like to know more about the steam presses which you are offering at cost price.
    - Etc.

Commercial Letter – Enquiries, Replies and Quotations (Cont.)

- ***Making Enquiries – Asking for samples, patterns, and demonstration***
  - *Asking for samples, patterns, and demonstration.*
    - We would also appreciate it if you could send some samples of the material so that we can examine the texture and quality.
- ***Making Enquiries - Suggesting terms, methods of payment, and discount.***
  - *Suggesting terms, methods of payment, and discount*
    - We usually deal on a 30% trade discount basis with an additional quantity discount for orders over 1,000 units.
    - Could you let us know if you allow cash discounts; etc.

Commercial Letter – Enquiries, Replies and Quotations (Cont.)

- ***Making Enquiries – Asking for goods on approval, or on sale or return***
  - *Asking for goods on approval, or on sale or return.*
    - The leaflet advertising your latest hobby magazines interested us, and we would like to stock a selection of them. However, we would only consider placing an order if it was on the usual basis of sale or return. If this is acceptable, we will send you a firm order.
    - Etc.

Commercial Letter – Enquiries, Replies and Quotations (Cont.)

- ***Making Enquiries – Asking for an estimate or tender***

  - *Asking for an estimate or tender.*

    - **Advertisement**: The Irish Tourist Organization invites tenders from building contractors to erect seating for 10,000 people for the Dublin Summer Festival. Tenders should be in by 1 March 2026, and wiII be assessed.
    - **Advertisement:** The Zena Chemical Company invites tenders from private contractors for the disposal of chemical waste. Only those licensed to deal with toxic substances should apply. Further details from...
    - Etc.

Commercial Letter – Enquiries, Replies and Quotations (Cont.)

- ***Making Enquiries – Closing***
  - *Closing.*
    - We hope to hear from you in the near future.
    - We would be grateful for an early reply.
    - Finally, we would like to point out that delivery before Christmas is essential, and hope that you can offer us that guarantee.
    - If you can agree to the concessions we have asked for, we will place a substantial order.
    - Etc.

Commercial Letter – Enquiries, Replies and Quotations (Cont.)

- *Enquiries*: Short enquiries could be sent by letter, fax, or email.

Request for a catalogue and price list

Dear Sir / Madam

Please would you send me your Spring catalogue and price list, quoting CIF prices, Le Havre?

Yours faithfully

F. Raval

F. Raval (M.)

Request for a prospectus

Dear Sir / Madam

I would like some information about your courses in English for Business Executives, beginning in July.

Please send me a prospectus, details of your fees, and information about accommodation in London for the period July to December. If possible, I would like to stay with an English family.

Yours faithfully

Y. Iwanami

Y. Iwanami (Ms)

Figure 2: Example of enquiries. Source: Ashley, A. (2020). Oxford Handbook of Commercial Correspondence.

Commercial Letter – Enquiries, Replies and Quotations (Cont.)

- *Reply to Enquiries*

Reply to a request for a catalogue and price list

▸ See page 42 for the request.

Dear Mr Raval

Thank you for your enquiry of 31 January. We enclose our Spring Catalogue and current price list quoting CIF prices Le Havre.

We would like to draw your attention to the trade and quantity discounts we are offering in our Special Purchases section on pp. 19–26, which may be of particular interest to you.

Please contact us if we can be of any further help.

Yours sincerely

Tim Hoad

Tim Hoad

Reply to a request for a prospectus

▸ See page 42 for the request.

Dear Ms Iwanami

Please find enclosed our prospectus covering courses from July to December. Details of fees and accommodation in London for that period are covered in the booklet 'Living in London' which accompanies the prospectus.

At present we still have places available for students taking the English for Business Executives course beginning in July, but would ask you to book as soon as possible so that we can reserve a place for you and arrange accommodation with an English family.

We are sure you will enjoy your stay here and look forward to seeing you.

Yours sincerely

M. Preston

M. Preston (Ms)

Figure 3: Reply fo enquiries. Source: Ashley, A. (2020). Oxford Handbook of Commercial Correspondence.

Commercial Letter – Enquiries, Replies and Quotations (Cont.)

- *Enquiries*: Short enquiries could be sent by letter, fax, or email.

Request for general information

Note that the reference to TRADE PRICES in this letter tells the manufacturer that he is dealing with a RETAILER or wholesaler, not a private individual.

If these examples were sent as email messages, it would be acceptable to remove the salutation and change the complimentary close from *Yours faithfully* to the less formal *Thanking you in advance.*

Dear Sir / Madam

Could you please send me details of your tubeless tyres which are being advertised in garages around the country?

I would appreciate a prompt reply quoting trade prices.

Yours faithfully

Brian Wymer

Brian Wymer

Figure 4 : Example of Enquiries. Source: Ashley, A. (2020). Oxford Handbook of Commercial Correspondence.

Commercial Letter – Enquiries, Replies and Quotations (Cont.)

- *Enquiries*: Short enquiries could be sent by letter, fax, or email.

Reply to a request for general information

See page 42 for the request.

Dear Mr Wymer

Thank you very much for your enquiry. I enclose a catalogue giving detailed information about our heavy goods vehicle tyres, including the impressive results we have achieved in rigorous factory and track tests. Please note especially the items on safety and fuel economy – the main selling points of this product.

With regard to trade discounts, we can offer 25% off list prices to bona fide retailers and wholesalers, with quantity discounts for orders over £20,000.00.

We would be pleased to supply any further information you require.

Yours sincerely

Darren Treadwell

Darren Treadwell

Figure 5 : Reply to Enquiries. Source: Ashley, A. (2020). Oxford Handbook of Commercial Correspondence.

Commercial Letter – Enquiries, Replies and Quotations (Cont.)

- *Enquiry from a buying agent*

Enquiry from a buying agent

Companies often have agents in other countries who sell or buy products for them ▸see pages 169–170. In this email the agent is acting on behalf of her PRINCIPALS in Canada.

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To... John Merton

Cc...

Subject: Our ref. 180/MB

Dear Mr Merton

You were recommended to us by your trade association and I am writing on behalf of our principals in Canada, who are interested in importing chinaware from England.

Could you send us your latest catalogue and price list, quoting your most competitive prices?

Our principals are a large chain store in North America and will probably place substantial orders if the quality and prices of your products are suitable.

Many thanks.

Linda Lowe
Director
Sanders & Lowe Ltd
Planter House, Princes Street
London EC1 7DQ
Tel.: +44 (0)20 7 87457
Fax: +44 (0)20 7 87458
Email: l.lowe@sanlo.co.uk

Figure 6 : Enquiry from buying agent. Source: Ashley, A. (2020). Oxford Handbook of Commercial Correspondence.

Commercial Letter – Enquiries, Replies and Quotations (Cont.)

- *Reply to Enquiry from a buying agent*

'Selling' the product

This is a reply to the buying agent who emailed Glaston Potteries ▸ see page 44 on behalf of her principals in Canada. As the agent made no reference to any particular line of chinaware she was interested in, and did not mention terms, this reply takes the form of a sales letter.

GLASTON POTTERIES LTD

Clayfield | Burnley | [illegible]

Telephone +44 (0)1282 [illegible]
Facsimile +44 (0)1282 [illegible]
Email j.merton@glaston.co.uk
www.glaston.com

10 June 20—

Ms L. Lowe
Sanders & Lowe Ltd
Planter House
Princes Street
London EC1 7DQ

Dear Ms Lowe

We were pleased to receive your enquiry today, and are enclosing the catalogue and price list you asked for.

You will see that we can offer a wide selection of dinner and tea services ranging from the rugged 'Greystone' earthenware breakfast sets to the delicate 'Ming' bone china dinner service. You can choose from more than fifty designs, which include the elegance of 'Wedgwood', the delicate pattern of 'Willow', and the richness of 'Brownstone' glaze.

We would very much like to add your clients to our worldwide list of customers, and could promise them an excellent product with a first-class service. We would be glad to accept orders for any number of pieces, and can mix sets if required.

You will see that our prices are quoted CIF to Eastern Canadian seaboard ports and we are offering a special 10% discount off all net prices, with delivery within three weeks from receipt of order.

If there is any further information you need, please contact us, or go to our website at the address above. Once again thank you for your enquiry.

Yours sincerely

J. Merton

J. Merton (Mr)
Sales Manager

Figure 7 : Reply to Enquiry from buying agent. Source: Ashley, A. (2020). Oxford Handbook of Commercial Correspondence.

Commercial Letter – Enquiries, Replies and Quotations (Cont.)

- *Enquiry from a retailer to a foreign manufacturer*

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To... Satex S.p.A.

Cc...

Subject: Sales enquiry

Dear Sir / Madam

We are a chain of retailers based in Birmingham and are looking for a manufacturer who can supply us with a wide range of sweaters for the men's leisurewear market. We were impressed by the new designs displayed on your stand at the Hamburg Menswear Exhibition last month.

As we usually place large orders, we would expect a quantity discount in addition to a 20% trade discount off net list prices. Our terms of payment are normally 30-day bill of exchange, D/A.

If these conditions interest you, and you can meet orders of over 500 garments at one time, please send us your current catalogue and price list.

We hope to hear from you soon.

Peter Crane
Chief Buyer
F. Lynch & Co. Ltd
Nesson House, Newell Street, Birmingham B3 3EL
Telephone: +44 (0)21 236 6571
Fax: +44 (0)21 236 8592
Email: pcrane@lynch.co.uk

Enquiry from a retailer to a foreign manufacturer

This email is from the Chief Buyer for a chain of shops in Birmingham to an Italian knitwear manufacturer. The buyer explains how he got to know about the manufacturer, and suggests that a quantity discount and acceptance of his method of payment would persuade him to place an order. He is stating his terms in his enquiry because he feels that as a BULK BUYER he can demand certain conditions. But you will see from the reply ▸ page 58 that, although the Italian manufacturer wants the order, he does not like the terms, and suggests conditions that are more suitable to him.

Figure 8 : Enquiry from a retailer to a foreign manufacturer. Source: Ashley, A. (2020). Oxford Handbook of Commercial Correspondence.

Commercial Letter – Enquiries, Replies and Quotations (Cont.)

- *Quotation of terms: Reply to Enquiry from a retailer to a foreign manufacturer*

Quotation of terms

This is a reply to the general enquiry in which Mr Crane, Chief Buyer at F. Lynch & Co, asked for certain concessions → see page 45. Notice how Sig. Causio of Satex does not turn down his requests but makes a counter-offer.

Satex S.p.A.
Via di Pietra Papa, 00146 Roma

Telefono: +39 (0)6 769910
Telefax: +39 (0)6 6815472
Email: causiod@satex.co.it

Vs. rif.: Vs. rif.: 6 Feb. 20—
Ns. rif.: D/1439

21 February 20—

Mr Peter Crane
Chief Buyer
F. Lynch & Co. Ltd
Nesson House
Newell Street
Birmingham B3 3EL
UK

Dear Mr Crane

We were pleased to receive your enquiry, and to hear that you liked our range of sweaters. We can confirm that there would certainly be no trouble in supplying you from our wide selection of garments.

We can offer you a quantity discount, which would be 5% off net prices for orders over £2,000, but the usual allowance for a trade discount in Italy is 15%, and we always deal on payment by sight draft, cash against documents. However, we would be prepared to review this once we have established a firm trading association with you.

Enclosed you will find our summer catalogue and price list quoting prices CIF London. We are sure you will find a ready sale for our products in England, as have other retailers throughout Europe and America, and we hope very much that we can reach agreement on the terms quoted. Thank you for your interest. We look forward to hearing from you soon.

Yours sincerely

D. Causio

D. Causio (Sig.)
Sales Director

Figure 9 : Reply to Enquiry from a retailer to a foreign manufacturer. Source: Ashley, A. (2020). Oxford Handbook of Commercial Correspondence.

In conclusion

- The Purpose of Formal Letters.
- Parts of a Formal Letter.
- Tone and Style.
- Commercial Letter –
  Enquiries, Replies and Quotations.

2. Applying For A Job

Job Advertisements

- Advertisements (often shortened to ads) for employment appear in all the media, including radio, television, the Internet, and etc.
- **Example**

  "Wanted, personal assistant for full-time employment in small manufacturing company. Good salary, five days a week, hours of work 9.00 a.m. to 5.00 p.m., usual benefits in terms of conditions and holidays."

Letters of Application

- ***Opening***
  - ❖ Generally, the terms 'vacancy', 'post', or 'appointment' are used instead of the word 'job' in applications.
  - ❖ When replying to a job advertisement, as with most correspondence, it is best simply to state what you are doing, and give a date or reference.
    - ➢ *I would like to apply for the post of Programmer advertised in this month's edition of Computers.*
    - ➢ *I was recommended by Mr. ABC, who is currently working in your company, to contact you concerning a possible post in your Department.*

Letters of Application (Cont.)

- ***Request for an application form***
  - ❖ If you are writing to ask for an application form, give some very brief details about yourself, then ask for the form.
    - ➢ *I am 23 years old, and have recently graduated from ____ with a diploma / degree in _____*
    - ➢ *At present I am working for ____, where I am employed as a _____ in the _____Department.*
- ***Closing***
  - ❖ There is no need to give any more information at this stage, so you can close the letter.
    - ➢ *Please could you send me an application form and any other relevant details?*

Application forms and CV

- When you receive an application form, always read it through carefully so that you know exactly what information is required.
- Some companies prefer a Curriculum Vitae, usually called a CV (resume in American English), which is your personal and working history.
- Application forms and CV may be emailed, faxed, or sent by post.

Covering Letters and Its Format

- You may need to send a covering letter with an application form or CV.
- ***Opening***
  - ❖ If the company has sent an application form, remember to thank them.
  - ❖ If you are enclosing a CV, mention it at the beginning of the letter.
    - ➢ *Thank you for your letter of ____ and the application form for the post of ____. I enclose the completed form / my cv.*

Covering Letters and Its Format (Cont.)

- ***Body of the letter***
  - ❖ Your covering letter should be short. If you need to develop or emphasize any points, do so briefly and simply.
    - ➢ *You will see that I graduated from ____ University / College in 20____, where I gained a degree / diploma / certificate in _____*
    - ➢ *During my employment with ____ my work was specifically concerned with ____*

(**Note**: Mention any parts of your studies relevant to the post / Mention work relevant to the post you are applying for).

Covering Letters and Its Format (Cont.)

- ***Reasons for leaving a job***
  - ❖ If you need to explain why you left a job, it is best to sound positive. Never say that you wanted a better salary, conditions or you were bored with your job…
    - ➢ *I left (old employer) because (new employer) offered me a chance to use my (languages, IT training, etc.)*
    - ➢ *I was offered a chance to join (company) where there was an opportunity for further training and experience in _____*
    - ➢ *Etc.*

Covering Letters and Its Format (Cont.)

- ***Previous experience***
  - Most application forms give some space to describe previous work experience, e.g. what your duties and responsibilities were.
  - Here you have a chance to highlight your achievements, e.g. any special responsibilities or projects you undertook, changes you made, or schemes you introduced.
    - *During my time at (company), I was responsible for marketing software services. A large part of this role involved successfully implementing change in the ...*

Covering Letters and Its Format (Cont.)

- ***Reasons for applying***
  - ❖ All prospective employers will want to know why you are applying for a specific job. This not only means explaining why you want the job, but why you think your particular skills and experience would be valuable to the company.
    - ➢ *I am particularly interested in the post as I could apply my previous experience in (area of work).*
    - ➢ *I have some experience of (area of work), and am enthusiastic about developing a career in this field.*
    - ➢ *Etc.*

Covering Letters and Its Format (Cont.)

- ***Closing***
  - ❖ At the end of the letter, offer to supply more information if necessary.
    - ➢ *I look forward to hearing from you. However, if there is any further information you require in the meantime, please let me know.*
    - ➢ *Please let me know if there are any other details you need. Mean while, I look forward to hearing from you.*
    - ➢ *I would be happy to discuss with you at the interview how my skills and experience could be used to your advantage; etc.*

Example of Unsolicited Letter and Reply

Unsolicited letter

Notice in this letter how the applicant first mentions how he knows of Mitchell Hill (a merchant bank), gives brief details of his education and experience, and then refers to his current employers, who approve of staff spending time abroad. Finally, he tells Mitchell Hill why he wants to join them temporarily, and asks for an application form. Of course, he could also include a CV with the letter, but in this case, he knows that company practice is to send application forms.

Fürstenweg 110
D–30000 Hanover 71

21 June 20—

Mr John Curtis
Manager
Mitchell Hill PLC
11–15 Montague Street
London EC1 5DN

Dear Mr Curtis

I am writing to you on the recommendation of David McLean, Assistant Manager in your Securities Department. We met last month on a course in Hanover, and he suggested that I should contact your company and mention his name. He told me that you often employ people from other countries on one-year temporary contracts, and I am writing to enquire about the possibility of such a post.

I am at present employed by the International Bank in Hanover, in their Securities Department. I have worked here since 20—, when I graduated from the University of Munich with a degree in Economics. In my present position as Assistant to Wolfgang Lüers, Director of the Securities Department, I deal with a wide range of investments from companies throughout Europe, buying shares and bonds for them on a worldwide basis. As well as speaking fluent English, I also have a good working knowledge of French.

I would like to spend a year in the UK to gain further experience in securities investment with a British bank, and believe that my experience, training, and language skills would prove useful to your organization. My employer encourages all its staff to spend a year abroad and Mr Lüers would be willing to give you a reference.

I would be grateful if you could send me an application form and further information about the posts currently available. If you need any further information, I can be contacted by email on bauerm@aol.com.de or telephone on 49 511 506941x155.

Yours sincerely

Marcus Bauer

Marcus Bauer

1. How did Marcus Bauer hear about Mitchell Hill?
2. What is his present post, and what does he do?
3. What are his qualifications?
4. Why do you think his bank encourages employees to work abroad?
5. What does he want Mitchell Hill to send him?

Figure 10 : Unsolicited Letter. Source: Ashley, A. (2020). Oxford Handbook of Commercial Correspondence.

Example of Unsolicited Letter and Reply (Cont.)

Reply to an unsolicited letter

Mitchell Hill plc

11–15 Montague Street
London
EC1 5DN

TELEPHONE +44 (0)20 7625 3311/2/3
FACSIMILE +44 (0)20 7625 4019
CABLE MITHIL (London)
EMAIL McLean@mithil.co.uk

29 June 20—

Marcus Bauer
Fürstenweg 110
D-30000 Hanover 71

Dear Herr Bauer

Thank you for your letter of 21 June 20—. We currently have two vacancies in the Securities Department which might be of interest to you.

I am enclosing an application form, and a booklet giving details of Mitchell Hill, including the salary structure and conditions of employment for trainees on temporary contracts. Would you please complete the application form and send it to Helen Griffiths, Human Resources Department, at the above address.

You will see from the form that we require two referees. I suggest that you include the names and contact addresses of your Director and an academic referee from the University of Munich.

We look forward to receiving your application.

Yours sincerely

Sheila Burrows

Sheila Burrows (Miss)
p.p. David McLean
Securities Manager

Figure 11 : Reply to An Unsolicited Letter. Source: Ashley, A. (2020). Oxford Handbook of Commercial Correspondence.

Example of Application Form

Application form

Application form Ref
Post

Mitchell Hill plc Merchant Bank
11-15 Montague Street London EC1 5DN

Personal

Surname (Mr Mrs Miss Ms) Bauer — Forename(s) Marcus
Maiden name — — Age 28 — Date of Birth 12 Nov 20–
Marital status single — No of children — — Ages —
Address Furstenweg 110, D-30000, Hanover 71
Tel daytime (49) 511-506941 x155 — Tel evening (49) 511 251068
Next of kin Mr Kurt Bauer, father (see above address)

Education

School/univ/college	From	To	Address
Secondary Friedrich-Ebert Gymnasium	20–	20–	Herrenhauser Str. D-30000 Hanover 21
Higher Universitat München	20–	20–	Hittorfstr. D-80000 München

Examinations

Title	Grade	Subject(s)	Date
Diploma	1	Business studies/ Economics	20–
Abitur	1		20–
LCCI Higher		Business English	20–
Cambridge Proficiency	B	English	20–

Languages

	Fluent	Good	Fair
French			✓
English		✓	

Have you any of the following skills?

IT skills: (Tick appropriate box)
- ☐ Spreadsheets
- ☐ Wordprocessing
- ☐ Desktop publishing (DTP)
- ☐ PowerPoint
- ☐ Database
- ☑ Keyboard skills
- ☑ Bookkeeping to TB

Accounts:
- ☐ Manual
- ☐ Computerized
- ☑ Telex
- ☑ Customer contact
- ☑ Driving Licence
- ☑ Filing

Employer's Name and Address	From	To	Position and duties	Salary
International Bank Georgenplatz 108 D-30000 Hannover 1	20–	20–	Assistant to Director of International Securities Dept. Buying and selling securities	£22,000

Names and addresses of two referees

Herr Prof. K. Weil, Universitat München, Hittorfstr., D-80000 München
Herr Wolfgang Lüers, Director, International Securities, International Bank, Harvesthunderweg 7–9, D–60373, Hanover 15

Hobbies/activities

Reading, chess, skiing, swimming, and tennis

Can we approach your Employer for a reference? ☑ Yes ☐ No
When will you not be available for an interview? Date (s) before 5 Sept.

Date 17 July 20– — Signature

Figure 12 : Application Form. Source: Ashley, A. (2020). Oxford Handbook of Commercial Correspondence.

Example of Cover Letter

25 Westbound Road
Borehamwood
Herts
WD6 1DX

18 June 20—

Mrs J. Hastings
Personnel Officer
International Computing Services plc
City Road
London EC3 4HJ

Your Ref: KH 305/9

Dear Mrs Hastings

I would like to apply for the vacancy advertised in the *Guardian* on 16 June for a Personal Assistant to the Sales Director.

As you will see from my CV, I am currently Personal Assistant to the Sales Manager of a small engineering company. In addition to the day-to-day administration work, I represent the Sales Manager on some occasions and am delegated to take certain policy decisions in his absence.

I speak good French and Italian, and use both languages in the course of my work.

I am particularly interested in this post as I would like to become more involved with an IT organization and am very familiar with many of your software products.

If there is any further information you require, please contact me. I look forward to hearing from you.

Yours sincerely

Carol Brice

Carol Brice (Ms)

Enc. CV

Covering letter with cv

In this example, notice that the applicant starts by referring to the job advertisement. She then goes on to expand on her present duties and give other information that she feels is relevant to the post. She also explains why she is applying for this particular vacancy. If, on her cv, she gives her current employers as REFEREES, she could mention that she would prefer International Computing Services not to approach them until after an interview.

Figure 13 : Cover Letter. Source: Ashley, A. (2020). Oxford Handbook of Commercial Correspondence.

Example of Curriculum Vitae

Curriculum vitae (cv) 1

There are a number of ways of presenting information in a CV. Traditionally, the sequence was name, address, contact details, marital status, education, qualifications, work experience, referees, and interests. However, it is now more common to begin with brief personal details, followed by a short profile or description of yourself (sometimes also called a CAREER SUMMARY). After that, the most important information is recent employment history, and skills and qualifications. In the interests of completeness, you should account for all years since leaving school, but if the information is irrelevant to the position you are applying for or is some years old, you should summarize it as briefly as possible.

These days, it is generally unnecessary to mention marital status, children, age, health, or current salary unless specifically asked to do so, but this will vary according to the law and custom in different countries.

Here is a typical CV for an experienced professional.

Wendy Benson
Chartered Statistician

Address	48 Danbury Road Amersham Bucks HP8 5SM
Telephone	01494 665093
Email	bensonw@amc.co.uk
Profile	— A highly competent qualitative and quantitative market researcher with wide experience in advertising, market research companies, government research, and production and retail organizations in the UK and overseas. — Highly numerate, with excellent communication skills. — Analytical, innovative, self-motivating, confident. — Able to lead or to work as part of a team. — Welcomes new challenges, especially if they involve implementing and developing schemes. — Experienced trainer and facilitator. — Fluent in French and German. — Computer literate.
Employment 2002–present	**Department of Employment** *Senior Market Research Officer*. Responsible for planning and implementing research on future government manpower requirements; formulated marketing strategies; conducted customer care study; set up database for labour-force survey. Organized statistical training courses for government staff at all levels. Responsible for a team of six market researchers.
1995–2002	**Universal Advertising PLC** *Assistant Director, Research and Planning Department*. Responsible for trade and consumer research; market information systems; market forecasting; trade and consumer analysis of existing and new business for marketing and sales departments. Managed two members of staff.
1991–1995	**MMBC Associates** *Market Researcher*. Involved in research on products and data relating to the retail food and beverage market.
Qualifications	MBA, Open University (part-time) 1995 Diploma of Institute of Statisticians 1991 BSc. (Mathematics and Statistics), University College, London 1990
Publications	See list attached.

Figure 14 : CV. Source: Ashley, A. (2020). Oxford Handbook of Commercial Correspondence.

Example of Curriculum Vitae (Cont.)

Curriculum vit (cv) 2

This is a typical cv recent graduate.

Adam Hall

Date of birth: 25 February 19—
Address: 25 Victoria Road, Birmingham B19 2ZK
Tel.: 0121 8953 9914
Email: adhall@interserve.net.uk

Profile
A highly-motivated, well-travelled, and creative graduate with practical work experience in both sales and TEFL teaching. A 4-month postgraduate residency at the Biosphere 2 Center, Arizona, has given me wide-ranging knowledge of, and insight into, environmental problems and ways of presenting them to the public.

Education

19— –19—	King Edward's School, Birmingham O Levels: Art, Biology, Chemistry, English, French, Geography, History, Maths, Spanish A levels: Art A Environmental Studies A Chemistry B Spanish B	
20— –20—	Leeds Metropolitan University BA Hons Environmental Studies:	2:1
July, 20—	Academy School of English, Leeds	Cert CELTA

Work experience

April 19— –July 19—	Weekend sales assistant, Kings Norton Garden Centre, Birmingham
January 20— –May 20—	TEFL tutor, JA School of English, Katowice, Poland

Other information

September 20— – December 20—	4-month residency at the Biosphere 2 Center, Arizona, USA
May 15–16, 20—	Co-presented 'No smoke ...' at the Bretton Hall Sculpture Park, University of Leeds. An installation which explored the environmental implications of major forest fires, both natural and man-made.
June 20–24, 20—	Co-presented 'Time microscope' at the Covent Garden Flower Festival. An installation which explored different ways of presenting information about the natural world.

Interests
My main interest outside work, although related to it, is travel. In 19— I took part in a school expedition to the High Atlas mountains in Morocco, and produced a video of the trip. In my gap year I travelled extensively in South America, again documenting the trip by means of sketchbooks and video. I also enjoy World Music, particularly that from countries I have visited, and play the *oud* (Moroccan lute).

References

Prof. T.N. Fagin
Department of Environmental Studies
Leeds Metropolitan University
LS2 3RX

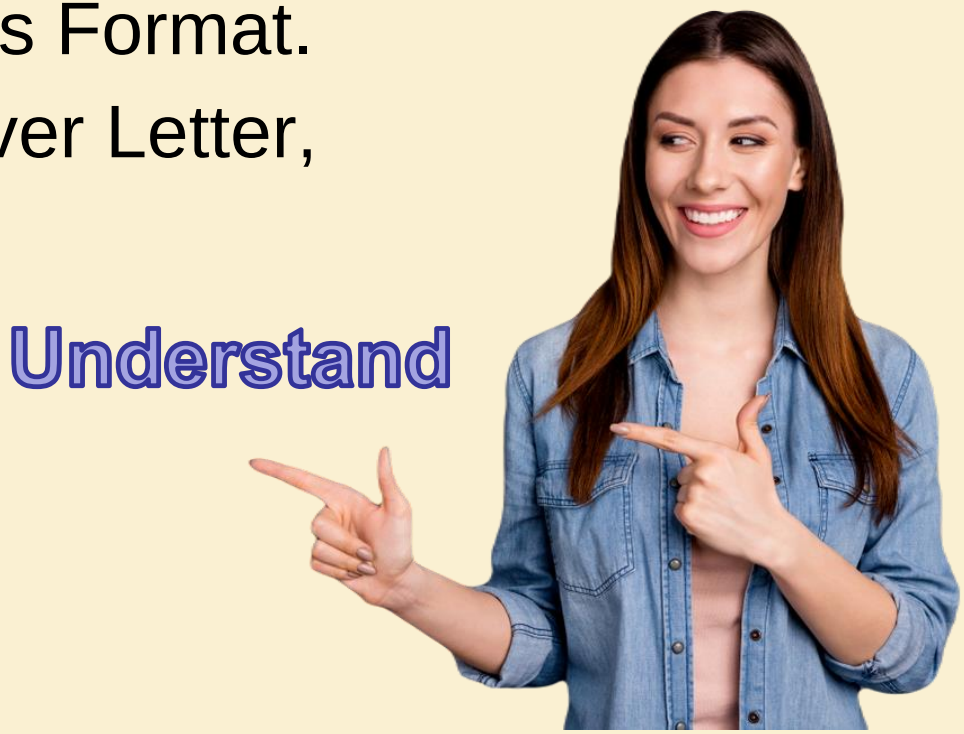
Dr Elzbieta Gordon
Principal
JA School of English
Ulica Czysta 14
Katowice
Poland

1 Where did Adam study environmental problems?
2 What did he do while he was in Poland?
3 Who is Dr Elzbieta Gordon?
4 What do you think Adam's main interest is?
5 Where did Adam graduate from?
6 What commerci experience has h had?

Figure 15: CV. Source: Ashley, A. (2020). Oxford Handbook of Commercial Correspondence.

In conclusion

- Job Advertisements.
- Letters of Application.
- Application forms and CV.
- Covering Letters and Its Format.
- Examples (Letters, Cover Letter, Application Form, CV).



3. Report Writing

Report

- It is any informational work made with an intention to relay information or recount certain events in a presentable manner.
- Reports are often conveyed in writing, speech, television, film, etc.
- A report is an administrative necessity.
- Most official forms of information or work are completed via a report.
- A report is always written in a sequential manner in order of occurrence.
- ***Types of Report***: Formal and Informal Report.

Informal Report

- The informal report functions to inform, analyse, and recommend.
- It usually takes the form of a memo, letter document, or a very short international like a monthly financial report, monthly activities report, research and development report, etc.
- This report differs from the formal report in length and formality.
- It is written according to organizational style and rules, but it usually does not include the preliminary (front) and supplemental (back) material.

Informal Report (Cont.)

- The informal report is usually more controversial in tone and typically deals with everyday problems and issues addressed to a narrow readership inside the organization.
- Types of informal report:
  - ❖ Progress report.
  - ❖ Sales activity report.
  - ❖ Personnel evaluation.
  - ❖ Financial report.
  - ❖ Credit report.
  - ❖ Etc.

Formal Report

- The formal report is the collection and interpretation of data and information.
- The formal report is complex and used at an official level.
- It is often a written account of a major project.
- The example of subjects includes
  - ❖ New technologies; The advisability of launching a new project line; Results of a study; etc.
- ***Types of formal report***
  - ❖ Informational reports; Analytical reports; Recommendation reports.

Informational Reports

- Informational reports present results for a particular problem or situation.
  - ❖ An example: A manager of a city's website might prepare an informational report for the city council; the report would provide statistics on the number of people who pay their city water and sewage bills online, etc.
- Informational reports might
  - ❖ Present information on the status of current research project.
  - ❖ Present an update of the operation in your division.
  - ❖ Explain how your organization or division does something.
  - ❖ Present the results of a questionnaire or research.

Analytical Reports

- This type goes a step beyond presenting results. Analytical reports present results, analyze those results, and draw conclusions based on those results.
- These reports attempt to describe why or how something happened and then to explain what it means.
- Like informational reports, analytical reports can be formal or informal.

Analytical Reports (Cont.)

- Explain what cause a problem or situation.
  - ❖ Present the results of a traffic study showing accidents at an intersection.
  - ❖ The report explains what it means.
- Explain the potential results of a particular course of action.
- Suggest which option, action, or procedure is best.

Recommendation Reports

- This type advocates a particular course of action. This usually presents the results and conclusions that support the recommendations.
- This type is identical to analytical report.
  - For example, your analytical report suggests using treatment X is more efficient than treatments Y and Z. However, that does not mean that you will use treatment X as cost and other considerations might recommend treatment Y.
- What should we do about a problem?
- Should we or can we do something?
- Should we change the method or technology we use to do something?

The Plan for Preparing A Formal Report

- Identify the readers.
- Determine your purpose.
- Formulate specific questions.
- Conduct research to answer the question.
- Draw valid conclusions (for analytical or recommendation reports).
- Decide on recommendations (for recommendations).
- Write the report.

Format of A Report

- Although there is no set report writing format, there are general sections that should be included.
- Unlike essays, reports are written in sections with headings and subheadings, which are usually numbered.
- There are numerous possible formats available for writing a report, and it mostly depends on the context of the topic.
- Below given are the components of a report in which they would occur:
  - ❖ Title page;
  - ❖ Acknowledgement;
  - ❖ Content page;
  - ❖ Abstract;
  - ❖ Introduction;
  - ❖ Body;
  - ❖ Conclusion;
  - ❖ References.

Format of A Report (Cont.)

- ***Title page***
  - ❖ It should include the title, your name and the name of the tutor to whom it is being submitted, date of submission, your course/department. The logo of the organization should also be printed.
- ***Acknowledgement***
  - ❖ A list of people and organization who have helped you in the compilation of the report and other related work.
- ***Content page***
  - ❖ A clear, well-formatted list of all the sections and sub-sections of the report. Page numbers should be marked correctly.

Format of A Report (Cont.)

- ***Abstract***
  - ❖ A summary of the major points, conclusions, and recommendations should be written to give a general overview of the report.
- ***Introduction***
  - ❖ The first page of the report needs to have an introduction. You will explain the problem and show the reader why the report is being made.

Format of A Report (Cont.)

- ***Body***
  - This is the main section of the report. There must be several sections, with each having a subtitle. The various sections include Review of Literature, Materials and Methods, and Results. A discussion section can also be included at the end of the body to go over the findings and their significance.
- ***Conclusion***
  - A conclusion should draw out the implications of your findings, with deductions based on the facts described in your main body. The significance and relevance of the study are discussed in this section.
- ***References***
  - This is a list giving the full details of all the sources to which you have referred within your text.

In conclusion

- Report.
- Informal and Formal Report.
- Informational, Analytical, and Recommendation Reports.
- The Plan for Preparing A Formal Report.
- Format of A Report.

THANK YOU
FOR YOUR ATTENTION

Q&A